



Instructor Introduction

Technical Product Manager Academy

Who I am, what to expect, how we'll work

About Me



John Kidd

- 20+ years building commercial software
- 20+ years teaching technology and related subjects
- First tech I taught: Lotus Notes
- Yes, I love Goldens!



Prerequisites

This academy assumes you:

- Completed the pre-work — PM Philosophies, Agile Methodologies, and Prompt Engineering
- Are comfortable with browser-based tools and a markdown editor
- Have working access to a generative AI assistant (ChatGPT, Claude, or equivalent)

Please note: if any of these is your first exposure, flag it now so we can pair exercises and pace appropriately.

Where This Fits

Adjacent skills you'll touch

- Prompt engineering & AI-augmented research
- System design & architecture trade-offs
- Stakeholder mapping & negotiation
- Agile delivery and ADO mastery

Where to go next

- Capstone artifact carries into your real product work
- Ongoing TPM mentorship inside Expeditors
- Skills/SkillIQ post-academy assessments



My Pledge to You

I will...

- Make this academy interactive — small-group breakouts every block
- Ask you questions — and welcome yours
- Make sure every voice in the cohort gets heard
- Create an inclusive learning environment
- Use an on-screen timer for breaks and lab timeboxes

If you have an accessibility need, please let me know — in chat, by email, or directly — and I'll adapt.



How We'll Work Together

- All materials live in the academy repo — decks under week-XX/presentations/, lab briefs under week-XX/labs/
- We'll use a generative AI assistant and a markdown editor — please install ahead per setup/TECH-SETUP.md
- Follow along in the day's lab brief
- Activities and labs are embedded in each day — come prepared to work in triads
- Ask questions any time — chat, raised hand, or unmute

Cohort Introductions

In ~30 seconds each, please share:

- Your name and pronouns
- Current role and team
- Where you're based
- A product you ship to today — internal or external
- A fun fact — one sentence



Recording & Notetaker Policy

Notetaker apps (Read AI, Otter, Fireflies, etc.) are not permitted in this session.

- The instructor will decline notetaker requests — no exceptions
- These tools capture more than shared text; they raise privacy and IP concerns
- For follow-up questions, reach out directly to the instructor

Thanks for your cooperation.



Ready to Begin

Welcome to the TPM Academy